ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: iRobot Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

Independent research and reviews · https://abvorn.com

We earn a commission if you buy through our links, at no extra cost to you. Our opinions are our own.

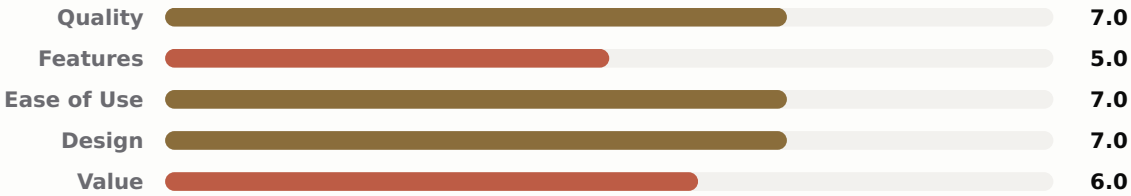
Choosing a robot vacuum in 2026 means balancing suction power, mopping features, navigation tech and ongoing costs. This guide breaks down the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo variants and the Shark AI Ultra line to help you find the right fit for your home.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why consider a robot vacuum in 2026?

Busy lifestyles, pet hair, and a mix of carpet, hardwood and tile mean you need a cleaner that works while you're elsewhere. The latest robot vacuums combine powerful suction, vibrating mop pads, self-empty docks and AI-driven navigation—delivering hands-free cleaning that cuts allergen load and saves you hours each week.

What are the key differences between the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo models and the Shark AI Ultra?



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo is offered in two versions:

- Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock – holds up to 60 days of debris.
- Roomba 115X Combo base model – same cleaning system, no dock.

Both share the 4-stage cleaning system and Imprint™ Smart Mapping.

The Shark AI Ultra line includes:

- Shark AI Ultra (standard)
- Shark AI Ultra AV2501S variant – differs mainly in price and bundled accessories.

Both use Shark's AI Laser Navigation and a self-cleaning brushroll.

How do suction power and mopping capabilities compare?

According to manufacturer specs:

- **Roomba 115X Combo**: up to 1800 Pa suction; vibrating mop pad makes ~200 passes per minute.
- **Shark AI Ultra**: up to 2200 Pa suction; sonic mopping mode vibrates at 1000 cycles per minute.

Both let you toggle vacuum-only or vacuum-plus-mop modes via their respective apps, giving you flexibility for carpets versus hard floors.

What navigation technology does each brand use?

iRobot – Imprint™ Smart Mapping builds a floor-plan after a few runs, lets you label rooms, set customizable virtual walls, and store multiple floor maps.

Shark – AI Laser Navigation employs a lidar sensor for real-time mapping, supports up to three floor plans, and offers no-go zones through the SharkClean app. Neither system requires a physical boundary strip.

How long does the battery last and what happens when it runs low?

The Roomba 115X Combo delivers up to 90 minutes of runtime on hard floors, automatically returns to its dock to recharge, then resumes cleaning where it left off.

The Shark AI Ultra provides up to 120 minutes of runtime and also features charge-and-resume. Actual runtime varies with suction mode and whether the mopping attachment is engaged.

Maintenance and ongoing costs

Both brands design for low-maintenance ownership:

- Filter replacement every 2–3 months (≈$15-$20 per pack).
- Brushroll cleaning is tool-free; Shark's self-cleaning roll reduces hair wrap.
- The Roomba AutoEmpty Dock holds up to 60 days of debris, emptying into a disposable bag (~$8-$12 each). The base model requires manual bin emptying after each run.
- Shark's dock includes a self-empty bag system with similar cost.

Factoring in consumables, the total yearly cost of ownership stays under $100 for either platform, making them budget-friendly upgrades over traditional vacuums.

Which robot vacuum should you choose?

If you value a proven mapping system, room-level control and the convenience of a 60-day self-empty dock, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock is the strongest pick.

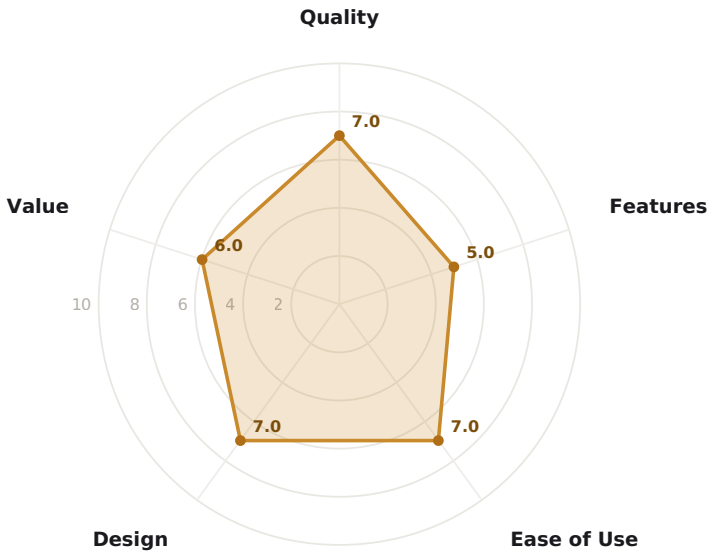
If you prefer higher suction power, a longer runtime and a slightly lower entry price, the Shark AI Ultra (or the AV2501S variant for extra accessories) delivers excellent performance.

Ready to upgrade your cleaning routine? Click the links above to see current prices, check availability, and enjoy free shipping on your next robot vacuum.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.